

The match is two days away, but tonight breaks from the plan: full speed and full rest, not an easy night.

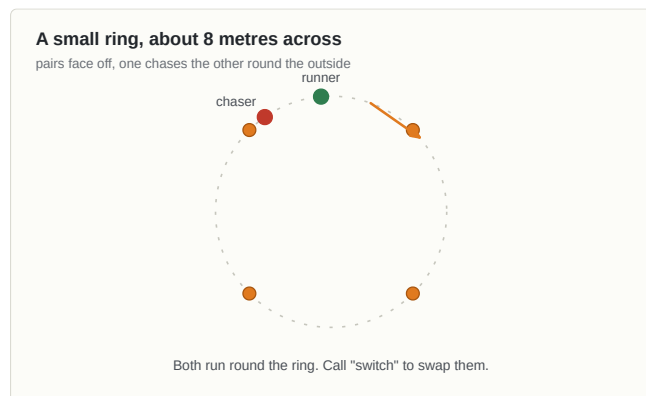
ON THE GROUND

- 10 cones: 4 for a small chase ring, and 4 more for the sprint, turn, weave and cut

1 minute setup. Set it up before the first group arrives and leave it for all three.



Sprint to the turn cone, weave through two, cut the last cone, sprint to the finish



A small ring about 8 metres across, one boy chasing another round the outside

1 to 6 Movement: round the ring

- Pair them up around the ring, facing each other, an arm's length apart.
- On "go", the runner moves around the outside of the ring and the chaser follows, trying to close the gap.
- Sharp changes of direction, not a flat sprint. Keep it under control.
- Call "switch" every thirty seconds, so the chaser becomes the runner.

6 to 11 Challenge game: sprint, turn, weave, cut

- Same pairs from the ring, lined up at the start, so nobody stands round wondering who goes next.
- One at a time. Sprint to the turn cone, plant the outside foot, and turn tight around it.
- Sprint on to the two weave cones and go between them, short choppy steps, not a straight line.
- Cut hard round the last cone and sprint the length back to the finish.
- Full rest between goes. Walking back and breathing easy before he goes again.
- Three goes each, no more. Quality goes first when they are tired and there is no point past that.

Coach one thing: The turn, not the sprint. A good plant and turn saves more time than a fast straight line.

- Boys who round the turn wide instead of planting and cutting tight.
- The pace goes up tonight, out of its usual place. Watch for tired legs going into Saturday.

Lashing rain. Take out the turn cone and the cut cone. Curves only tonight, no hard plant and turn on wet grass.